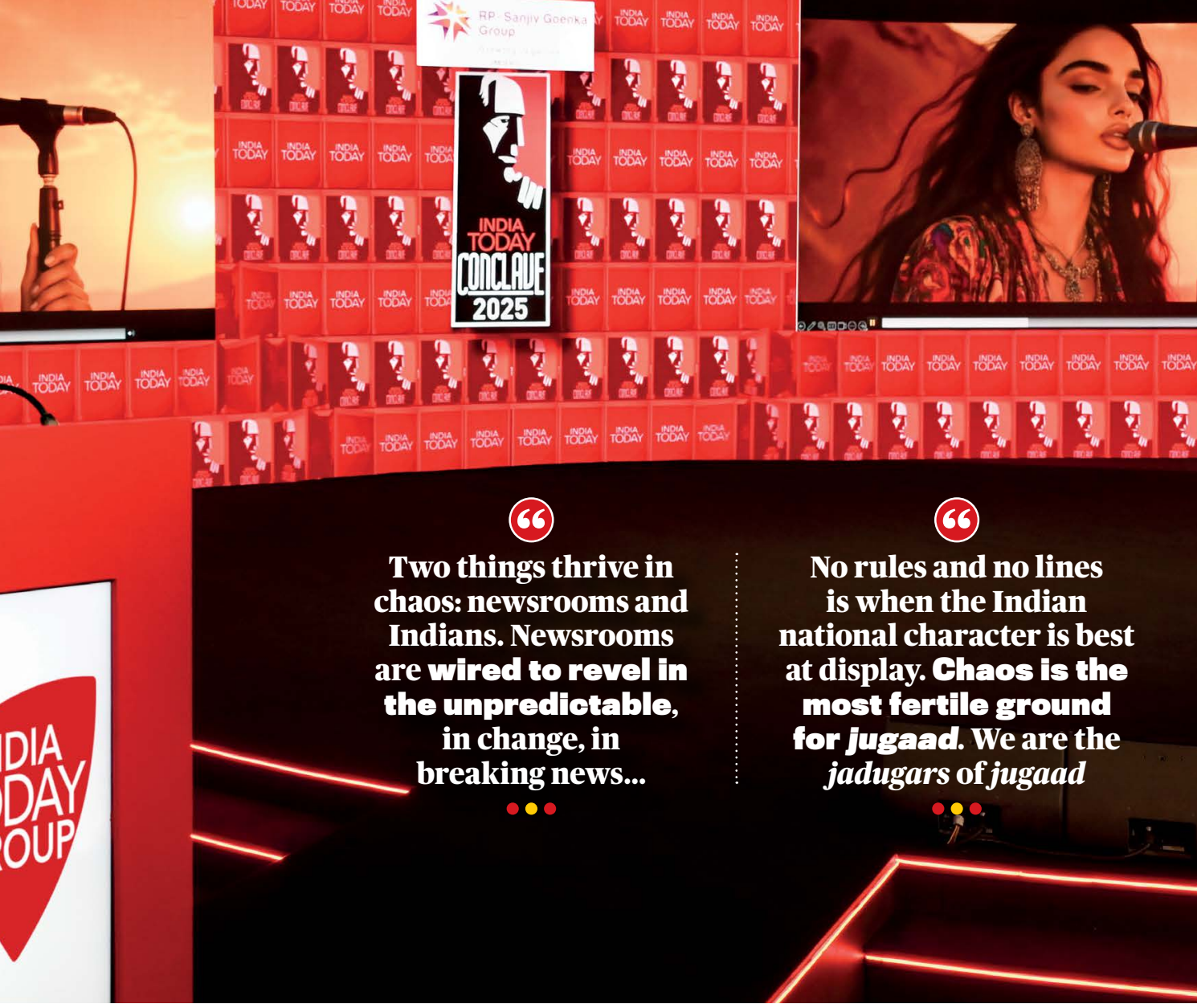


Two things thrive in chaos: newsrooms and Indians. Newsrooms are wired to revel in the unpredictable, in change, in breaking news...

No rules and no lines is when the Indian national character is best at display. Chaos is the most fertile ground for *jugaad*. We are the *jadugars* of *jugaad*

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

champions of chaos. When there is no plan, we shine. Chaos is the most fertile ground for *jugaad*. We are the *jadugars* of *jugaad*, it is what makes us master innovators.

I find myself fortunate heading an Indian newsroom in the very best of times. The icing on this cake is having 50 years of credibility and supportive sponsors. In times of chaos, you rely only on those that you trust, those that will navigate you through the turbulence. An Indian newsroom with credibility. It seems I have ALL the cards.

Two years ago, we had launched India's first AI news anchor, Sana. And we have not stopped since then. Today, we are taking another leap... we are introducing Aishan, our first AI-generated pop star. Everything about him—his looks, his voice, his music, his video—is AI-generated. Even his smile is AI-generated. With Aishan, we are introducing a new genre of music for the world. We call it...A-POP.

A-POP is not robotic. It is humans partnering with machines to create a new sound. Lyrics written by humans, composed by AI, sung by AI. Or sometimes the other way around. A-POP is fluid, it is electronic, it is collaborative, it is the new frontier of music. AISHAN is our first AI Popstar. But he won't be alone! Joining him is the electrifying female Pop Star—Ruh—with her foot-tapping single 'Rehna Tere Saath'. Ruh opened for real-life Honey Singh's concert in Indore.... Her music is very addictive, and it gets stuck. As you know, AI doesn't eat drink or sleep, so they are on to their new projects. I am excited to see what comes out of this collaboration. It is an exciting journey ahead. And today is just DAY ONE.

In conclusion, I want to remind you the rarest mineral of all on this earth is your attention and your time. Everyone is out to get it, from the politicians to the tech oligarchs. And it's in short supply. Basic economics. I ask you to raise your price. Negotiate hard. Make the best deal you can. Spend your time and attention on things that value YOU, enhance YOU, respect YOU, augment YOU. Not the ones that make you a commodity and sell you without your permission. You have done well by choosing to spend time with us. I hope we continue to make ourselves worthy of your time and attention. ■

To watch the full session, visit **https://bitly.cx/CWSts**